ASSETPLUS

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The retiree with most money in FDs

Rekha, 61: the story, the conversation, and the numbers to show



In short: Rekha's FDs are safe but taxed every year. Moving ₹10 lakh of money she will not need for 2+ years into a hybrid SIF earned 7.51% against 6.11% in the last 12 months, before tax.



Rekha, 61

Retired teacher · 30% tax slab · illustrative story

Rekha retired two years ago. Her pension covers the household, and ₹80 lakh sits in FDs across three banks. Every March she pays tax on interest she never touched. She is careful, and she trusts you because you never pushed her.

"I don't want to gamble. I just want my money to do a little better."

The conversation

PARTNER
How much of your FD money will you not need for 2 years?

CLIENT
Maybe ₹10 to 15 lakh. The rest I want close.

PARTNER
Then keep the rest in FDs. For ₹10 lakh, a hybrid SIF made ₹75,100 in a year; the FD ₹61,100.

CLIENT
And if markets fall?

PARTNER
In March 2026 it lost about ₹19,000 on ₹10 lakh, and recovered. The FD never dips. That is the trade.

Before and after ₹ lakh



Why a SIF may fit

- Steadier than equity: the middle hybrid SIF fell 1.9% in March 2026 when the Nifty fell 11.3%
- Taxed only when she redeems, not every year
- Keeps her emergency money in FDs; only surplus moves

Numbers to show % return; after tax for a 30% slab investor

	Last 12 months	After tax (30% slab)	March 2026 (Nifty −11.3%)
Bank FD (SBI 1 year)	6.11%	4.28%	0.51%
Hybrid SIF, middle fund	**7.51%**	**6.01% or 5.26%**	**−1.92%**

Objections you will hear

They say	You can say
"I cannot afford any loss."	Keep 2 years of spending in FDs. A hybrid SIF had 4 losing months in 12; the worst was about 2.4% for the middle fund.
"FDs are insured."	Yes, up to ₹5 lakh per bank. A SIF is not insured; it is regulated by SEBI and its assets are held by a custodian.
"I need monthly income."	Keep the income from FDs or a withdrawal plan; the SIF is for the part that can grow.

Not suitable if

- Needs the money within 2 years
- Cannot accept any monthly loss
- Has less than ₹10 lakh of surplus

Next steps on AssetPlus

- Check her KYC and nominee details
- Pick a hybrid strategy; note its risk band and redemption days
- Review together after 6 months

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